

ZACHARY BUTLER

Short-Form Video Strategist

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🌐 ctrlz.cc

SOCIAL

in zachary-butler

PROFILE

Short-form video producer and strategist with 3+ years building a social audience from nothing — grew The Solid Verbal podcast's presence to 22k TikTok and 11k Instagram followers while developing the weekly production workflow to sustain it. Backed by a decade of professional experience across high-volume YouTube, documentary storytelling, and branded content.

SKILLS

Technical Proficiency

- ▶ Adobe Premiere Pro
- ▶ Adobe After Effects
- ▶ DaVinci Resolve
- ▶ Adobe Audition
- ▶ Frame.io
- ▶ TikTok / Instagram / YouTube
- ▶ Google Suite

Core Competencies

- ▶ Short-Form Video Strategy

EXPERIENCE

SHORT-FORM VIDEO PRODUCER

2023 - Present | The Solid Verbal | Freelance

Built the podcast's short-form video presence from zero, developing both the content strategy and a repeatable weekly production workflow in direct collaboration with host Ty Hildenbrandt

Grew to 11k Instagram and 22k TikTok followers over three years; early videos averaged ~1k views; top video of last season reached 450k views on TikTok; videos now routinely clear 100k views

Designed clip formats that translate long-form podcast audio and on-camera segments into platform-native short-form content for a college football audience that spans every demographic and political affiliation

FOUNDER / PRODUCER

2025 - Present | Lesson Zero Studio | Laramie, WY

Founded a video production studio; built all client-facing workflows, brand identity, and operational infrastructure from scratch

Produced commercial content for clients including Zembla (online quiz bowl platform), managing full pipeline from casting and directing through edit, color grade, and delivery

INSTRUCTIONAL MEDIA PRODUCER

2021 - 2025 | Cornell University

Drove a 5x increase in views and 2x increase in subscribers for the department YouTube channel over four years through documentary-style video about the Cornell teaching and student experience

Directed on-camera performance with faculty subjects — coaching non-professional talent to communicate complex ideas clearly and authentically for a broad, non-specialist audience

Produced *Nobody's Fault: An Interactive Experience in Data Science Practice*, a branching-narrative video for a data science ethics course; made a technically complex issue feel human and actionable for non-specialist viewers

EDITOR

2017 - 2020 | FBE, INC

Edited 2-3 videos per week averaging 1-2M views for the REACT and REPLAY YouTube channels — built strong instincts for pacing, hooks, and what keeps audiences watching at scale

Developed and implemented new post-production workflows that improved efficiency across the editor and assistant editor team

- Audience Growth from Zero
- Repeatable Format Development
- On-Camera Voice Development
- Production Workflow Design
- Platform-Native Editing
- Digital Engagement

EDUCATION

MASTER OF ARTS

2008 - 2010 | University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
Film, Television, and New Media Studies

BACHELOR OF ARTS

2004 - 2008 | University of Montevallo
English Literature

PRODUCER/EDITOR — FREELANCE

2013 - 2024 | Various Clients

Documentary Feature — Produced, directed, and edited; winner of Audience Choice at San Francisco Black Film Festival — experience building audience connection around a mission-driven story

Burning Sofa — Podcast and social media video production

Wizards of the Coast — Edited videos for the Magic: The Gathering channel for a large, passionate enthusiast community

EDITOR

2015 - 2017 | DEFY Media

Edited branded content for major clients including Google, Sony, Kellogg’s, and Blizzard Entertainment across DEFY MEDIA brands including Smosh and Clevver TV

ADJUNCT INSTRUCTOR

2010 - 2013 | University of Montevallo

Taught first-year composition and literature survey courses to classes of 24-30 students; developed facility for explaining complex ideas clearly and speaking effectively to politically and culturally diverse audiences